

Things go better with Quark?

By Chris Reidy

Think about it: Things go better with Quark? A Rose by any other name may smell as sweet but likely wouldn't sell as well

1. As Reebok International Ltd. found out last week, coming up withⁱ a good name for a new product isn't always easy.

i. Come up with means to create, produce, invent.

2. "The most important piece of marketing is naming," claims Sam Birger, a cofounder of Whatchamacallit Inc., a small naming firm with offices in Cambridge and Mill Valley, Calif. "It's the handshake, the first impression."

3. Reebok made a bad impression with a shoe it called the Incubus. According to the dictionary, an incubus is an evilⁱⁱ spirit who has sex with women while they sleep.

ii. Evil means wicked, bad;

4. Embarrassed, the Stoughton-based footwear giant(巨头) said it plans to implementⁱⁱⁱ new guidelines for checking product names.

iii. The synonyms of implement are carry out, enforce, put into force, to cause to apply.

5. The art of naming a product or a company is increasingly big business—whether it's done within a company's marketing department or whether outside forces are brought in to help. 1) Finding an appropriate, nonoffensive^{iv} name, say companies, can have a direct effect on sales, and in some cases can mean success or failure.

iv. Nonoffensive means acceptable, serviceable, feasible, agreeable.

6. Because so many different methods are used, it's hard to say how much US companies spend on naming new products. Some companies sponsor(赞助, 资助, to provide support to) in-house competitions. Others seek help from their ad agencies and design firms. And still others use naming consultants who can charge anywhere from \$20,000 to \$250,000 for their services.

7. In return for such fees, these consultants often agree to remain anonymous. Just as some politicians don't like it to be known that their principles were shaped by public opinion polls, many corporations(=company, firm) don't like to admit that they needed outside help to come up with a new name.

8. Cadillac used a variety of sources to name its new Catera. A search begun in 1993 reviewed^v more than a thousand options, including Pegasus, Helios and Ascent, Cadillac said. After winnowing(=select 遴选) the list several times, eight names were submitted(hand in, turn in) to focus group in "three US cities as well as Paris, Dusseldorf and the Far East," Cadillac said.

v. Here, review does not mean to look back on, as in "session review"(课程回顾); review in the context means to examine closely, study critically.

9. In part, Catera was chosen for its European flavor(taste, 风味) and also because the name is inoffensive (=nonoffensive) in a variety of languages, an important consideration in a global economy.

10. 2) Indeed, names that are perfectly serviceable in English can suffer in translation. Could

Duracell's name be a factor in why its European battery sales have not always met expectations?

11. Duracell sounds suspiciously like a French phrase that means “difficult to defecate” or “hard stool,” said Robert Sprung, chairman of Harvard Translations, a Boston-based foreign language consulting firm with revenues(profits, 收益) of about \$3 million.

12. (Duracell disputes(oppose, argue against, disapprove of) Sprung's interpretation.)

13. Elinor Selame, president of a Newton, [Massachusetts]-based firm called Brand-equity International, noted that using a name that makes customers uneasy^{vi} can cost a company millions of dollars.

vi. Uneasy means uncomfortable, anxious, 不适的; it is an adjective. Its noun form is unease.

14. As an example, she cited the Harlem Savings Bank, which bought another bank in the mid-1980s. 3)When Harlem Savings put its name on some of its newly acquired(=recently developed) suburban branches, “deposits(=money) walked out the door,” Selame recalled.

15. The bank found that the word Harlem evoked^{vii} negative connotations^{viii}(内涵意义) for many suburbanites, and it hired Selame's firm to find an agreeable new name. Rechristened the Apple Bank for Savings, the bank quickly gained new customers, Selame said, adding that Brandequity doesn't simply choose a name; it seeks to integrate a name with(融合) a corporate logo and marketing plan.

vii. Evoke means to bring to mind, to produce a strong feeling or memory, 唤起, 激起;

viii. Connotation vs Denotation

Denotation 就是词汇本意; Connotation 表示内涵意义。For example, the denotation of *Hamlet* one of the four great tragedies of Shakespeare, while the connotation of *Hamlet* refers to a person who hesitates.

《哈姆雷特》的本意指的是莎士比亚四大悲剧的其中一部作品或者它的男主人公, 而哈姆雷特的内涵意义指的是一个犹豫不决的人。(哈姆雷特最出名的句子是“to die or not to die” 他是一个犹犹豫豫, 瞻前顾后的人)

Or, “mother” denotes the female parent, while “mother” connotes love, family and warmth.

16. “Verbal and visual should work hand in hand,” she said. “You have to consider how a name will look on signs and business cards and how it will be used in advertising.

17. In the case of the Harlem bank, Selame's company showed it's client a color scheme, a lettering typeface and an advertising tagline(标签语, 宣传语): “Apple Bank. We're good for you.”

18. “If we had just showed them a name—Apple Bank—they probably would have turned us down(refuse, 否决, 拒绝),” she said.

19. Because new products constantly flood the market, it's hard to find clever names that someone else isn't already using.

20. And, as Avon Products Inc. found out earlier this month, using someone else's name can have unfortunate results.

21. A recent Avon catalog made numerous mentions of the word “Maxx,” prompting a lawsuit by the TJX Cos. Of Framingham, which operates the T.J. Maxx chain of offprice apparel stores(服装

店).

22. To avoid lawsuits(诉讼, 官司), naming consultants often turn to(seek help from) made-up words, and searches for made-up words frequently begin with lists of morphemes. A morpheme, according to linguists^{ix}, is the smallest fragment of language that conveys meaning.

ix. A linguist refers to an expert who studies language; linguistics is a discipline, 语言学;

23. Car companies are especially keen(passionate, ardent, enthusiastic 热衷于) on morpheme-derived(源于) names(=names derived from morphemes).

24. Using morphemes, a San Francisco firm called Namelab Inc. came up with Acura for the line of luxury cars that Honda introduced in the United States several years ago.

25. The morpheme “acu” connotes precision and care in several languages, said Ira Bachrach, president of Namelab, a company with about \$1.5 million in annual(=yearly) revenues.

26. 4) According to Bachrach, the made-up word—Acura—helped exorcise(驱除) the impression that Japanese companies could make only economy^x cars that did not deserve to be mentioned in the same breath(=equally) as Mercedes and BMW.

x. Economy without “the” means thrifty 节省, 节俭; Economy with “the” means the structure of economic life in a country. 因此, **With the development of economy and society 这个句子是错的**; 必须在 economy 前面加 **the** 才正确。正确的句子是: With the development of **the economy** and society...此处的 economy cars 表示经济实惠车。

27. Catera is also supposed to^{xi} suggest a European commitment(devotion, dedication) to luxury and engineering. Focus groups told Cadillac they thought of a “cat or a fast-moving, agile object” when they heard the word Catera.

xi. Be supposed to means to be expected to do, be meant to do. 比如, You are supposed to hand in your notes before 3rd Dec.. 表示老师期待的是12月3号之前你要提交笔记; 但真正是不是能够在3号之前提交笔记是不确定的。所以, 原文的 Catera is also supposed to suggest a European commitment to...means that the name Catera is created with the intention to show Europe’s devotion to luxury cars. But whether the name can actually achieve that effect is still unknown. 但实际这个名字到底能不能达到效果, 是不确定的。

xii. Don’t confound **agile** with **fragile**. Attention should also be paid to **agility** and **fragility**.

28. Lawsuits aren’t the only reason to prefer made-up names to real words. In the mid 1980s, a company toyed with(=play, amuse) calling a computer printer “the Shuttle,” but when the space shuttle Challenger blew up(爆炸了), the company became afraid customers would associate the name with a disaster, said linguist Sprung. (这就是吊儿郎当取名字的后果。)

29. To generate lists of morpheme-based names, some consultants use computers, but not Namelab, which relies on linguists.

30. “We’ve wasted a couple of hundred thousand bucks trying to come up with software” to help choose names, Bachrach said.

31. “Intellectually, it’s a far more arduous(laboursome, difficult, strenuous) process than you might think,” Bachrach said of matching a name to a product.

32. “Whether real or made up, names should be ‘short, memorable, relevant’ and immune to(free

from 不受某物干扰) lawsuit,” said Whatchamacallit’s Birger.

33. It also helps if a name is easy to pronounce in many languages.

34. By Bachrach’s lights, the name Coca-Cola represents a perfect marketing haiku. 5) Like a Byronic scholar scanning a poem for rhyme and meter(这两个词通常一起使用，表示韵律), Bachrach noted(=point) that Coca-cola is not only short and visually memorable, but it also pleases the ear by being “alliterative(头韵), assonant(元音韵), repetitive and iambic(抑扬格调).”(大家注意一下，这四个词不要求会拼写，但要求了解词义。)

35. Most consultants agree that a great name won’t sell a bad product, but opinions can vary about the effect of an unfortunate name on the sales of a good product.

36. In Europe, a US company has had success with a desktop publishing tool called Quark Express even though Quark sounds like a German word for cottage cheese, Sprung said.

37. However, in “The REchoning,” a book about the auto industry, author David Halberstam noted that the habit of giving cars lame(蹩脚的, poor, bad) names was one of several reasons why Datsun and Toyota had trouble cracking the US market in the early 1960s.

38. Americans were not enamored^{xiii} of cars with names such as Bluebonnett and Cedric. And a car that Datsun planned to market as the Fair Lady seemed destined to do little better.

xiii. Be enamored of means to be extremely attracted, fascinated or inflamed with passion by...

39. Then, at the last minute, the name was changed to the 240-Z, and a sports car was on its way to becoming a legend.